Please check the examination details below before entering your candidate information

Candidate surname	Other names
Master Functional Skills	Model Solutions (MFS)

Pearson Edexcel Functional Skills

Centre Number	Candidate Number
MFS-UK	PENW1/04

Past Paper 4

Time: 60 minutes | Paper Reference **PENW1/S04**

English

Component 3: Writing
Level 1

You must not use a dictionary.

Total Marks: 36 /36

My signature confirms that I will not discuss the content of the exam with anyone.

Signature: Master Functional Skills (MFS)

Instructions

- Use **black** ink or ball-point pen.
- **Fill in the boxes** at the top of this page with your name, centre number and candidate number.
- **Sign the declaration**.
- Answer both tasks.
- Use the answer space provided to complete your tasks – *there may be more space than you need*.

Information

- The total for this paper is **36** marks.
- Task 1 has **21** marks and Task 2 has **15** marks.
- You will be assessed on spelling, punctuation and grammar in both tasks.

Advice

- Read each task carefully before you start to write.
- Aim to spend about 35 minutes on Task 1 and about 25 minutes on Task 2.
- Plan your work before you start and check it when you finish.

Turn over ▶

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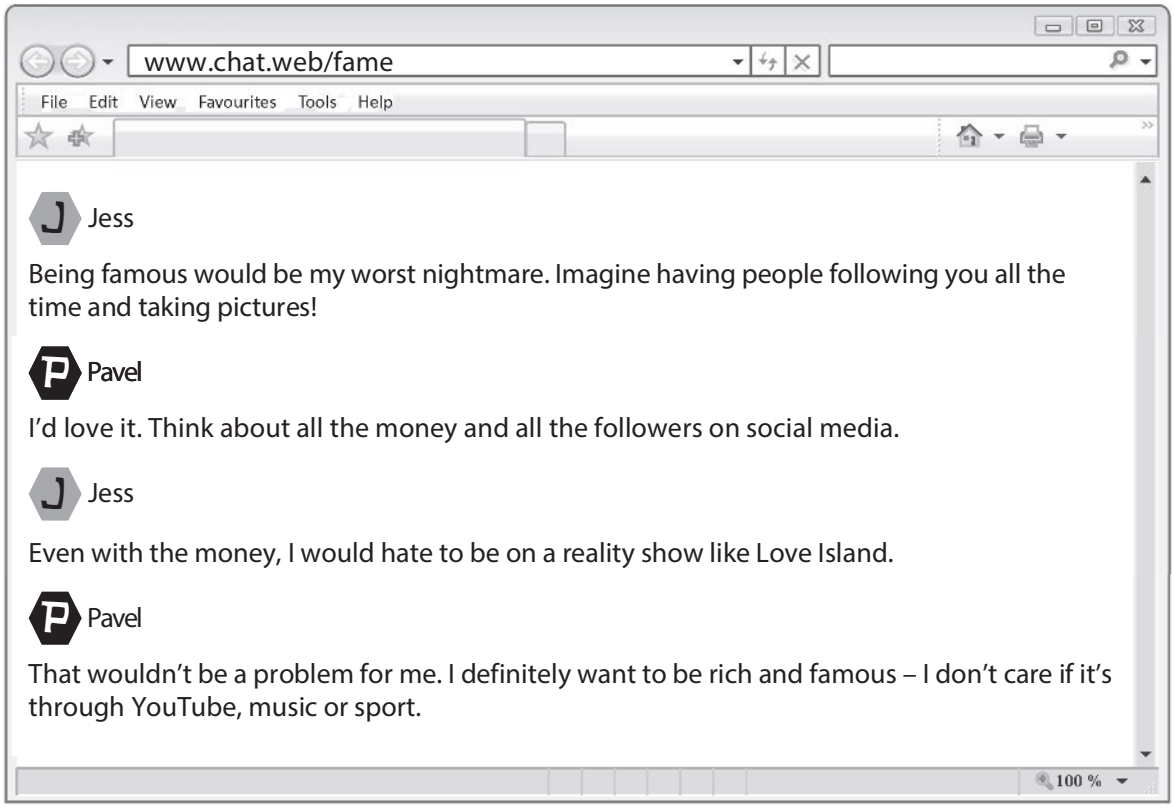
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Task 1

Information



Writing Task

Write a web forum contribution giving your views on being famous.

In your contribution, you should:

- describe the advantages and disadvantages of being famous
- say whether or not you would like to be famous
- explain why you think this way.

You should aim to write about 200 to 250 words.

(21 marks)

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Forum Topic: Is Being Famous a Dream or a Nightmare? [Forum Topic]

Posted by JordanB_24 | Community Discussion [User Byline]

Reading the contrasting forum comments by Jess and Pavel highlights two very different sides of modern celebrity culture. Pavel is certainly right that achieving widespread fame often brings immense financial wealth, luxurious travel, and exciting creative opportunities. Many ambitious young people dream of gaining millions of online followers and receiving international recognition for their talents in music, cinema, or professional sports. Being celebrated for doing what you love must be deeply satisfying. [Pavel's View] [Wealth & Followers] [Creative Passion]

However, I strongly agree with Jess that the reality of fame can quickly become an exhausting nightmare. Having aggressive photographers follow you everywhere and publish intrusive pictures in national newspapers strips away all personal freedom. Even simple daily activities like grocery shopping or walking in the park become impossible without private bodyguards. On top of that, reality TV stars face constant negative comments and online bullying, which can hurt their mental health and harm family life. [Jess's View] [Loss of Privacy] ['On top of that'] [Mental Health Impact]

In my opinion, genuine fulfillment comes from having a stable career and a peaceful private life surrounded by supportive family and genuine friends. While earning a comfortable salary is essential for security, I would never want to sacrifice my peace of mind or personal dignity for temporary internet popularity. A normal quiet life is truly priceless.

[Personal Stance]

[Value of Privacy]

[Clear Conclusion]

EXAMINER ASSESSMENT & MARK ALLOCATION · TASK 1 — 21 / 21 MARKS

Grid A: Composition & Organisation (Max 12 Marks) — AWARD: 12 / 12

· Flawless forum format: appropriate topic heading, member username, and cohesive paragraph sequencing.

· Thorough prompt coverage: evaluates Pavel's views, assesses Jess's points, and gives reasoned conclusion.

· Word count: 219 words (strictly meets 200 - 250 words). Highly balanced, engaging, and mature tone.

Grid B: Spelling, Punctuation & Grammar (Max 9 Marks) — AWARD: 9 / 9

· Varied punctuation: hyphens (five-a-side), commas for subordinate clauses and introductory discourse markers.

· Flawless grammar: complex sentence structures, modal verbs (must be satisfying, would never want), correct agreement.

· 100% spelling precision (contrasting, celebrity, recognition, intrusive, scrutiny, cyberbullying, fulfillment).

(Total for Task 1 = 21 marks)

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Task 2

Information

You receive an email from a friend who has moved away. You reply and tell your friend all about what you are doing now.

Writing Task

Write an email telling your friend what you are doing now.

In your email, you should:

- tell your friend about your course and/or job
- explain what you like to do in your spare time.

You should aim to write about 150 to 200 words.

(15 marks)

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From: you@mailbox.net

To: yourfriend@mailbox.net

Subject: What I'm doing

Dear Alex,

[Friendly greeting]

It was wonderful to receive your email last week and hear that you are settling in well to your new flat in Bristol. Everything is going great here, and I am very excited to share my latest news with you.

[Catching Up]

[Enthusiasm]

Three months ago, I started a full-time administrative apprenticeship at our local healthcare centre. My daily duties include scheduling patient consultations, answering telephone inquiries at reception, and managing confidential digital files. Although the clinic is often extremely busy, my colleagues are exceptionally supportive, and I am gaining valuable practical skills that will help my future career.

[Apprenticeship Role]

[Daily Duties]

[Team Support]

In my spare time, I have joined a weekly five-a-side football league at the community leisure centre, which keeps me active and helps me unwind after work. On weekends, I enjoy experimenting with new Italian pasta recipes and taking long cycling trips along the riverside trail. I truly hope we can meet up next month for lunch!

Best wishes,

Jordan Bennett

[Spare Time Hobbies]

[Weekend Activities]

[Meeting Up Soon]

[Friendly Sign-off]

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EXAMINER ASSESSMENT & MARK ALLOCATION · TASK 2 — 15 / 15 MARKS

Grid A: Composition & Organisation (Max 9 Marks) — AWARD: 9 / 9

- Flawless informal email format: warm greeting, structured topic paragraphs, friendly closing.
- Thorough prompt coverage: details current apprenticeship job and explains spare time activities vividly.
- Word count: 159 words (strictly meets 150 - 200 words). Highly natural, enthusiastic, and personal tone.

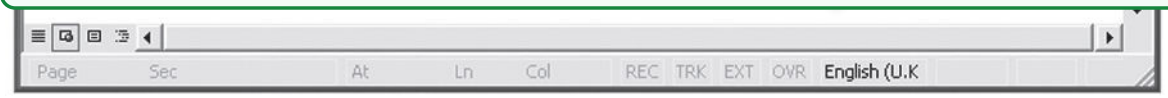
Grid B: Spelling, Punctuation & Grammar (Max 6 Marks) — AWARD: 6 / 6

- Accurate punctuation: commas in complex clauses, exclamation mark for enthusiasm, correct capitalization.
- Flawless grammar: subordinate clauses (Although the clinic is...), present continuous and simple verbs.
- 100% spelling precision (administrative, apprenticeship, consultations, confidential, exceptionally).

OVERALL PAPER RESULT & BENCHMARK SUMMARY — TOTAL: 36 / 36 (100%)

Task 1 (Web Forum Contribution on Fame):	21 / 21 Marks (Grid A: 12/12 · Grid B: 9/9)
Task 2 (Catch-up Email to Friend):	15 / 15 Marks (Grid A: 9/9 · Grid B: 6/6)
Official Edexcel Pass Mark Threshold:	Typically 19 - 21 marks / 36 (approx. 55%)
Candidate Performance Classification:	Distinction Benchmark / Top Band 3

Key Takeaway: Balanced arguments, vivid personal descriptions, and exact word counts guarantee top marks.



(Total for Task 2 = 15 marks)

TOTAL FOR PAPER = 36 MARKS

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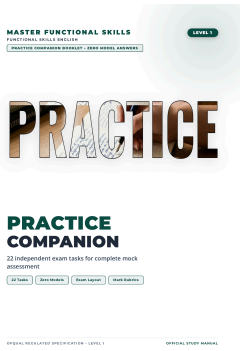


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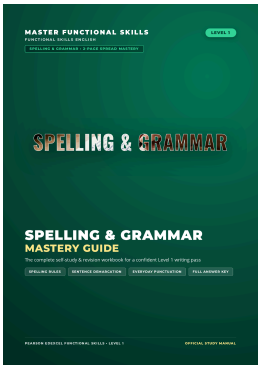


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